

SAMPLE REPORT. Northfield Supply Co. is a made-up company. This shows what a Meridian technology checkup delivers. Real reports use only what we observed and what you told us.

MERIDIAN SYSTEMS · TECHNOLOGY CHECKUP FINDINGS

Northfield Supply Co.

Business: industrial supply distributor, 24 staff, one location + warehouse

Checkup: 30 min on site, 6 Oct 2026

Met with: owner and office manager

What you run today

- Sage 100 on a server in the back office (bought 2018)
 - Shopify web store for online orders
 - Google Workspace email; shared Excel files on the server
- 22 PCs: 9 still on Windows 10
 - Backups to a USB drive plugged into the server
 - IT handled by the office manager's nephew, as needed

What we found, ranked

#	Finding	Why it matters to you	Risk	What you told us
1	The monthly reports can't be trusted.	Sales and stock reports pull from Sage through a connection that stopped refreshing after the last update. Nobody noticed for three weeks, and only Maria knows how it works.	High – cost	"Month-end takes three days, and I don't fully trust the stock numbers."
2	The web store and Sage drift apart.	About 40 web orders a day reach Sage by hand and stock counts drift. Wrong items have shipped.	High – cost	"About 8 hours a week, and two wrong shipments last month."
3	Backups have never been restored. The USB drive stays plugged in.	Ransomware encrypts attached drives. If the server fails, recovery time is unknown — possibly days without Sage.	High – risk	"We've never tried to restore anything."
4	Cyber-insurance renewal in 60 days; no multi-factor login on email; 9 PCs on Windows 10.	Your insurer's questionnaire asks about MFA, endpoint protection, tested backups and supported devices. Today, 3 of 5 answers would be "no".	Medium – deadline	"The broker said premiums may go up."
5	No one owns IT or the connections. No list of passwords, licences or who to call.	When the nephew is unavailable, problems wait. Knowledge lives in one person's head.	Low – ongoing	"We call him when something breaks."

What it's costing you (your numbers)

Rebuilding reports by hand each month: about 3 days, or 24 hours ≈ **288 hours a year**, about **\$6,900** in staff time at \$24/hour. Moving web orders by hand: 8 hours a week ≈ **416 hours a year**, about **\$10,000**. Both come before the cost of a wrong reorder or a wrong shipment. One day without Sage stops invoicing and shipping for all 24 people.

What we'd fix first

#	Fix	Result	Effort
1	Secure the basics: multi-factor login, endpoint protection, protected off-site backup with a tested restore	Insurance questions answered "yes" before renewal; recovery time known and written down	1–2 weeks
2	Rebuild the report connection so the monthly numbers refresh on their own, alert you if they fail, and are documented with a named owner	Numbers you can trust; month-end in hours, not days; anyone can fix it	1–2 weeks
3	Connect Shopify to Sage 100 so web orders and stock stay in step, with an exceptions list for anything odd	About 8 hours a week back; fewer shipping errors	2–4 weeks
4	Upgrade or replace the 9 Windows 10 PCs on a schedule that doesn't stop work	Supported, secure PCs; no ESU fees	2–3 weeks

Next step: a 20-minute call to walk through this page. Pricing comes in a separate fixed-price proposal; monthly support can keep all of the above secure and working. No obligation — this report is yours to keep. Observation only: nothing on your systems was changed. Meridian Systems LLC · (947) 622-4250 · meridiandatacom.com